

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Earth, fire and water ... which is most destructive?



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- If you could watch a natural phenomenon take place, what would you choose to observe?
- Of the four elements (earth, fire, air, and water) which do you think is the most destructive?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about geography, climate and environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that happened or have happened.
- I can report facts about events or actions using words like *what* and *whatever*.





Let's Explore!

Let's go **volcano watching***!

* "Volcano watching" is a hobby for some people. They camp out and observe an active volcano while taking photos, notes or videos over time.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Have you ever seen a volcanic eruption? I clearly remember the day Mt. St. Helens erupted because what I saw was unforgettable. Since the scene took place, it has been locked in my memory. I won't forget it! I was trailer camping in Washington State with my father that week. We, like most people in the area, were there to "volcano watch".

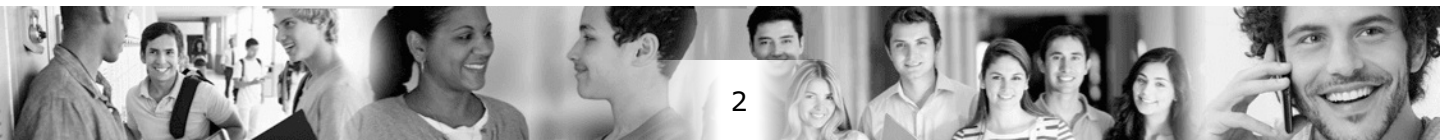
Since the eruption had been predicted weeks in advance, everyone was waiting for the show to begin. No one realized what a dramatic show it would be!

That morning, I was making breakfast when my father was finished setting up the camera that we had always kept focused on the mountain. I remember what I heard: my father gasped so I came out to see what was happening.

What met my eyes was startling. It looked like one whole side of the mountain was gone, replaced by an enormous gray cloud that was expanding very quickly. Soon, it hid the entire mountain from view and seemed to be shooting thousands of feet in the air.

Since that day, I have not seen or felt anything to match what happened next. What we heard was a low rumble, and the ground shook slightly as we stood there, dumbfounded. After a few minutes, it dawned on us that not only was a dark cloud growing rapidly, but it was coming straight at us!

We grabbed the camera after snapping whatever we could of the eruption, dived into the car, and drove as quickly as we could away from the volcano. We could hear rocks and bits of hard ash bouncing against the top of the car, but we made it out of the area safely. That eruption was magnificent, and I have not experienced anything like it since. My father said that he too was both frightened and amazed. We have made a promise to look at the pictures we took once a year. We always remember that experience!





Let's Practice!

Pete narrates how everything happened.

Instructions: Read and analyze each sentence. Write the numbers under the corresponding category.

1. I clearly remember the day Mt. St. Helens erupted because what I saw was unforgettable.
2. I have not experienced anything like it since.
3. I won't forget it!
4. My father said that he too was both frightened and amazed.
5. We always remember that experience!
6. We have made a promise to look at the pictures we took once a year.

Past event with a connection to the present

Past event with no connection to the present

Not a past event



Let's Practice!

Here is Pete's dad's view of the event.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write the sentences correctly.

1. erupted, / St. / I / because / Mt. / what / saw / remember / Helens / I / unforgettable. / was

2. eyes / What / met / startling. / was / my

3. ground / shook / a / we / low / heard / rumble, / What / the / . / was / and / slightly

4. the / of / whatever / camera / after / could / grabbed / snapping / eruption. / We / the / we

5. chaos / remember / caused / town. / among / is / it / all / the / that / from / What / day / the / I





Extension Activity

Think of the most dangerous experience you've ever had.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of one of the most dangerous experiences you've ever had.
- Tell your partner the story, talking about things that happened or have happened.
- Explain exactly where, when and how the event happened. Tell your partner that he/she has to listen well enough to tell the story to someone else.
- Listen to someone else's story or go online and find a story about someone surviving an avalanche, hurricane, earthquake or volcano.
- Take notes.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I tell a story about a dangerous experience.

☐ ☐

I use the Present Perfect and the Simple Past tenses.

☐ ☐

I use words like what and whatever.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **unforgettable** (adjective): memorable
e.g. I clearly remember the day Mt. St. Helens erupted because what I saw was unforgettable.
- **trailer camping** (noun): going on holiday in a house on wheels
e.g. I was trailer camping in Washington State with my father that week.
- **to gasp** (verb): inhale suddenly in surprise, pain or shock
e.g. I remember what I heard: my father gasped, so I came out to see what was happening.
- **to shoot** (verb): to push upward and outward quickly
e.g. Soon, the cloud hid the entire mountain from view and seemed to be shooting thousands of feet into the air.
- **rumble** (noun): a deep low sound
e.g. What we heard was a low rumble, and the ground shook slightly as we stood there.
- **slightly** (adverb): in a small amount of degree
e.g. What we heard was a low rumble, and the ground shook slightly as we stood there.
- **dumbfounded** (adjective): so shocked or surprised that one cannot speak
e.g. What we heard was a low rumble, and the ground shook slightly as we stood there, dumbfounded.
- **to dawn on** (expression): to slowly be made aware
e.g. After a few minutes, it dawned on us that not only was the dark cloud growing rapidly, but it was coming straight at us!





Learning Points

Present Perfect and Simple Past

Sometimes it can be difficult to know when to use the Present Perfect Tense and when to use the Simple Past Tense, since both of them are used to talk about actions that began in the past.

You use the **Present Perfect** to:

1. Talk about recent events, with no definite time

For example:

*We **have just bought** a new car.*

1. Talk about events that happened at some unknown or unmentioned time in the past

For example:

*I **have been** to Cuba three times.*

1. Talk about past events that have a connection to the present

For example:

*I don't want to see that movie. I've **already seen** it.*

1. Talk about things which began in the past and are still true

For example:

*I **have lived** here for ten years.*

1. Talk about a habitual action that has been occurring frequently up to the present

For example:

*I **have been working out** recently.*

You use the **Simple Past** to:

1. Talk about events that occurred at a specific time in the past

For example:

*I **bought** a car last week.*

1. Talk about things that started and ended in the past.





Learning Points

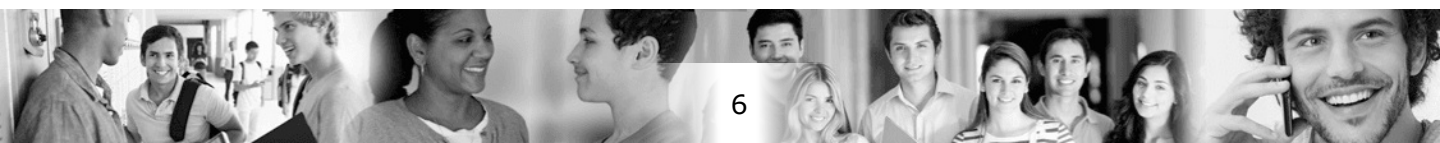
For example:

*I **lived** there for ten years.*

Look at a few more examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Since the scene took place, it has been locked in my memory.*
- *I have not seen or felt anything to match what happened next.*
- *That eruption was magnificent, and I have not experienced anything like it since.*
- *We have made a promise to look at the pictures we took once a year.*





Learning Points

Relative Clauses: **What** and **Whatever**

You can begin a clause with *what* or *whatever*. These are known as noun clauses and they can replace a noun or a noun phrase in a sentence.

What replaces *a thing* or *the things*.

In a sentence like "I couldn't believe the news," *the news* is a noun phrase. A *what* clause can be inserted into that part of a sentence.

For example:

*I couldn't believe **what Mike told me** yesterday.*

You can also use a relative *what* clause at the beginning of a sentence.

For example:

***What you should do** is talk to your lawyer.*

Whatever can be used in a similar way.

For example:

*When you're old enough to live on your own, you can do **whatever you want**.*

***Whatever you do**, don't tell the teacher.*

Take a look at these examples from the text:

Examples:

- *What met my eyes was startling.*
- *No one realized what a dramatic show it would be!*
- *I clearly remember the day Mt. St. Helens erupted because what I saw was unforgettable.*

